

HIPAA Privacy Rule Overview (Healthcare Domain Knowledge)

Protected Health Information (PHI) includes names, addresses, dates, medical record numbers, and any data that can identify a patient.

Covered entities must: obtain patient consent for uses beyond treatment, payment, and operations; implement administrative, physical, and technical safeguards; provide Notice of Privacy Practices; and report breaches.

Minimum Necessary Rule: only the minimum PHI needed for a task should be accessed or disclosed. Access controls and audit logs are required.

Patients have rights to access records, request amendments, and receive an accounting of disclosures. Systems must support these workflows.